

6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale NSW 2577

Historical Farming, Agricultural Use and Land-Clearing Evidence Summary

Date: 30 April 2026 | Property reviewed: 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale NSW 2577; Lot 4 DP746930 / proposed Lot 2 in unregistered subdivision.

Executive conclusion. Based on the material reviewed, the evidence supports the position that the subject land sits within the historic Bong Bong / Bulwer-Lytton Road locality, an area recorded in Austermere Estate material as cleared, ploughable and suitable for agricultural, dairy, orchard and farming use by 1904. The contract of sale provides the modern title and map bridge connecting 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4 DP746930 to that older locality.

Scope Reviewed

This summary reviews the exchanged contract of sale supplied by Dropbox link, the title search and plans inside that contract, the planning certificate, NSW Cadastre data queried for Lot 4 DP746930, the 1904 Austermere Estate sale material, State Library subdivision-plan references, and previously located historical sources. It focuses on evidence that may support prior farming, agricultural use, grazing, orchard/dairy use, or historical clearing of the land.

Key Findings

Finding	Evidence / source	Strength
The modern property is Lot 4 DP746930 in the Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Contract page 43 title search: Folio 4/746930, Lot 4 in DP746930, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Strong for legal identity.
DP746930 was created by subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 in 1987.	Contract scanned plan page 44: DP746930, "Subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513", Moss Vale, Bong Bong, Camden.	Strong for parent-title bridge.
The land is in the Bulwer Road / Lytton Road area.	Contract plan page 44 shows Lytton Road and road-widening context. NSW Cadastre polygon for Lot 4 DP746930 places the parcel beside Bulwer Road and north of Lytton Road.	Strong for location.
Austermere Estate material records agricultural/farming suitability and clearing by 1904.	NLA 1904 Austermere Estate plan and catalogue record describe land as "large area cleared & ready for plough" and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farms.	Strong for wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality; not yet direct title-chain proof for Lot 4.
The contract does not directly say Lot 4 itself was farmed.	Search/OCR of contract text, title search, scanned Gazette pages and annexures found title/easement/planning material but no direct phrase such as "Lot 4 was farmed" or "cleared for agriculture".	Important limitation.

Contract Review

The contract is useful mainly as a title and location document. It identifies the sale land as 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale, part of Lot 4 DP746930, with a proposed unregistered subdivision. The prescribed documents include title search material, an unregistered plan, the current deposited plan, older easement/title documents, Crown purchase-related material, and the 2023 planning certificate.

Relevant contract references:

Contract page	Observation	Use for farming/clearing question
Page 1	Identifies the property as 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale; Lot 2 in an unregistered plan, part of Lot 4 DP746930; Part Folio Identifier 4/746930.	Confirms modern property identity.
Page 4	List of prescribed documents includes old system document and Crown purchase statement of account.	Shows deeper historical title material may exist beyond the bundle.

Contract page	Observation	Use for farming/clearing question
Page 43	Title search confirms Lot 4 DP746930 at Moss Vale, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Connects land to historical parish/county records.
Page 44	DP746930 plan shows subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513, registered in 1987, with Lytton Road and surrounding road geometry.	Gives key parent-title step before the modern lot.
Pages 232-248	Planning certificate confirms current E4 General Industrial zoning and that agriculture/farm buildings are prohibited under current zoning.	Current zoning does not prove historic use.

Historical Farming / Clearing Evidence

The best direct historical evidence remains the Austermere Estate sale material. The 1904 sale plan for Moss Vale Austermere Estate describes the estate as including a “large area cleared & ready for plough” and markets the land for residential sites, orchard blocks, dairy and agricultural farms. Separate NLA/State Library references also describe Austermere material as suitable for farming, dairying, grazing and market gardens. This supports a defensible “cleared by at least 1904” position for the wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality.

Evidence Strength Matrix

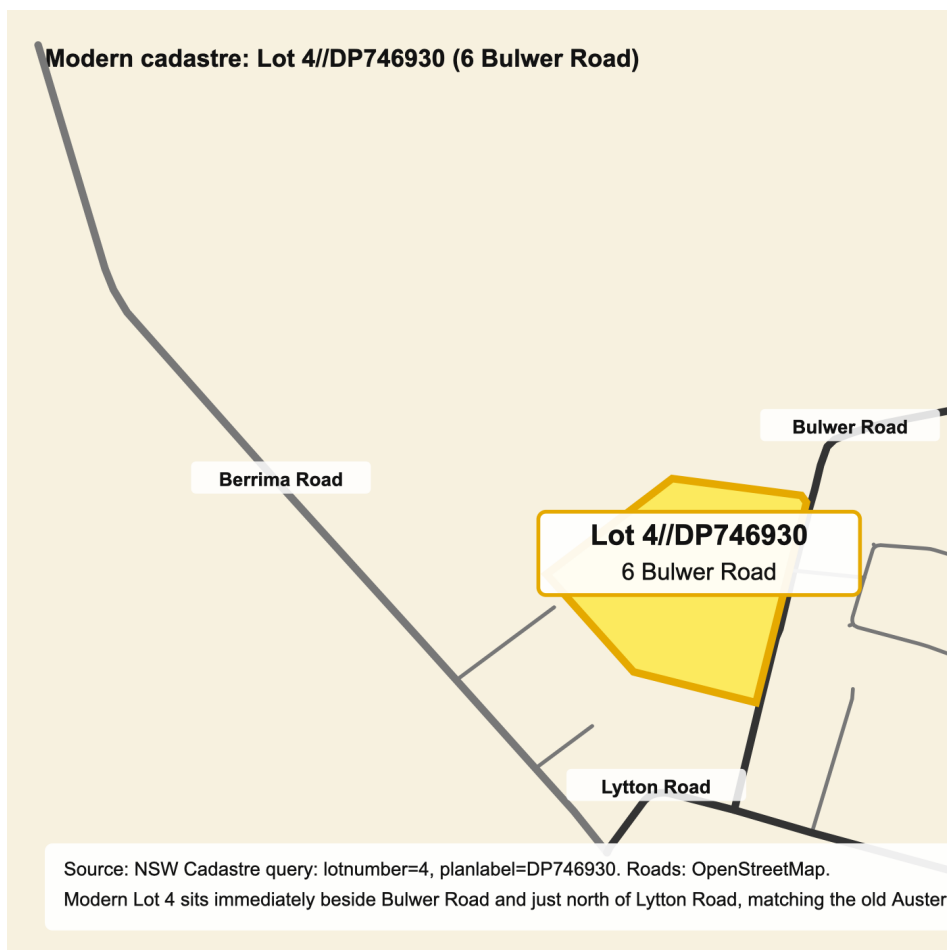
Evidence item	What the evidence supports
Contract title search	Confirms the legal identity of the land as Lot 4 DP746930 in the Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.
DP746930 plan	Shows modern Lot 4 was created from Lot 2 DP580513 and places the land around the Lytton/Bulwer Road area.
NSW Cadastre overlay	Places Lot 4 beside Bulwer Road and just north of Lytton Road, aligning the modern parcel with the historical Bulwer/Lytton locality.
Austermere 1904 material	Records the historical Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality as cleared, ready for ploughing, and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farming by 1904.
Historical aerial imagery, next research step	Can add visual confirmation of open paddock/farmland character and later disturbance periods across the subject parcel and surrounding locality.

Recommended Next Research

- **Order NSW LRS historical title chain:** start with Lot 4 DP746930, then parent Lot 2 DP580513, then earlier folio/volume references and any Crown grant/old system abstracts.
- **Download historical aerial imagery:** use NSW Spatial Services Historical Imagery Viewer for earliest available Moss Vale frames, then compare 1940s/1950s/1960s imagery against the Lot 4 boundary.
- **Request Council historical property files:** ask Wingecarribee Shire Council for files against 6 Bulwer Road, Lot 4 DP746930, Lot 2 DP580513, Bulwer Road, Lytton Road, Berrima Road and the Moss Vale Enterprise Corridor.
- **Find any Phase 1 Environmental Site Assessment:** these reports usually include aerial-photo interpretation and site-history tables identifying former agricultural/grazing use.
- **Review Parish of Bong Bong maps and Crown plans:** identify the Crown portion(s) that became Lot 2 DP580513 and check whether they were granted/selected as rural, agricultural, grazing or cultivated holdings.
- **Contact local archives:** Berrima District Historical & Family History Society and State Library NSW local subdivision-plan collections may hold additional Austermere/Bulwer Road plans or sale notices.

Visual Exhibit A: Modern Cadastre Overlay

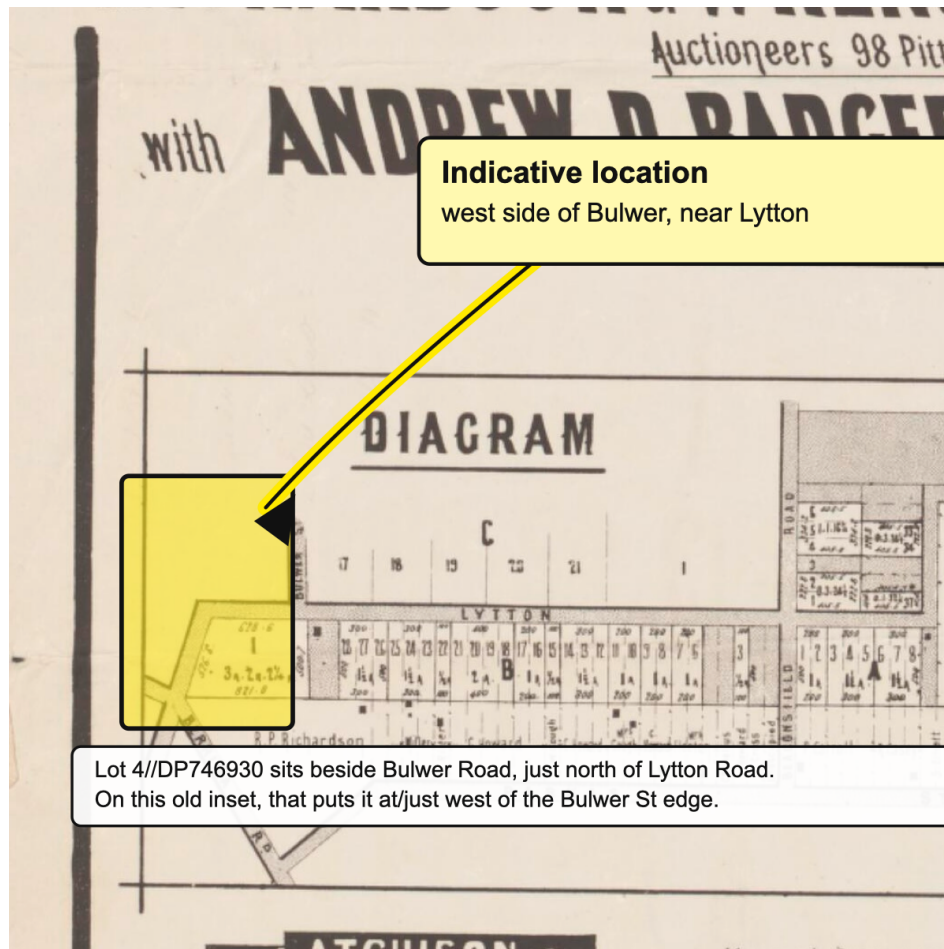
NSW Cadastre data queried for lotnumber=4 and planlabel=DP746930 places Lot 4 beside Bulwer Road and just north of Lytton Road.



Note: visual prepared from NSW Cadastre Feature Layer geometry and OpenStreetMap road geometry for orientation.

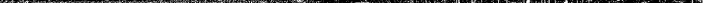
Visual Exhibit B: Indicative Austermere Inset Layout

The old Austermere inset uses historical lot/road layout and does not show modern street numbers. The indicative position places the modern land at/just west of the Bulwer Street edge, near Lytton Road.



Important: this is an indicative visual correlation, not a surveyed overlay.

The contract-included DP746930 plan identifies the modern deposited plan as a subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 and shows local road context including Lytton Road.



Sources Reviewed

- Exchanged Contract for Sale: 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale, signed by purchaser, downloaded from Dropbox link supplied by James. Local copy: ~/MDS/mds-diversified/research/bulwer-road/contract-6-bulwer-road.pdf.
- NSW LRS Title Search within contract, Folio 4/746930, search date 22 August 2023.
- DP746930 plan within contract, scanned page 44; subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513, registered 1987.
- Wingecarribee Shire Council Planning Certificate S10.724/0403, dated 25 August 2023, within contract.
- NSW Cadastre ArcGIS Feature Layer queried for planlabel=DP746930 and lotnumber=4.
- National Library of Australia: Moss Vale Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904. <https://nla.gov.au/nla.obj-230332818/view>
- National Library of Australia catalogue records for Austermere Estate / Moss Vale promotional subdivision material.
- State Library NSW Moss Vale subdivision plans list. <https://content-lists.sl.nsw.gov.au/tabular-list/moss-vale-subdivision-plans>
- NSW Spatial Services Historical Imagery information page. https://www.spatial.nsw.gov.au/products_and_services/aerial_and_historical_imagery

Summary Position

Based on the evidence reviewed, the land at 6 Bulwer Road is strongly associated with a locality historically used and promoted for farming and agricultural purposes. The modern title and deposited plan place the land in the Parish of Bong Bong and in the Bulwer/Lytton Road area. The Austermere Estate material for this same historical locality records land as cleared, ready for ploughing, and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farms by 1904. On that basis, the evidence supports the conclusion that the land formed part of a historically rural and agricultural landscape and that clearing for farming/agricultural use had occurred in the area by at least 1904.

Caveat

This report is an evidence summary prepared from available documents and public research material. It is not legal advice, a registered survey, a contamination assessment, or a formal historical land-use assessment. A solicitor, surveyor, environmental consultant or title search specialist should be engaged if the conclusions are to be used for legal, planning, financing or environmental due diligence purposes.

Parish Map and Crown Plan Review Addendum

This addendum reviews digitised Parish of Bong Bong maps and the contract title/plan material to help assess whether the 6 Bulwer Road locality was historically rural, agricultural, farmed or cleared for farming purposes.

Summary finding. The 1942 and 1968 Parish of Bong Bong maps support the view that the Bulwer/Lytton Road locality sat within a broader rural cadastral landscape made up of large acreages and named holdings. The maps show nearby holdings associated with William Hutchinson, John Waite, Charles Throsby, William Byrne and others, and identify the area through parish portions, old roll references and large-acreage landholdings rather than modern industrial lots. This adds support to the farming/agricultural history already shown by the 1904 Austermere material.

Map Sources Reviewed

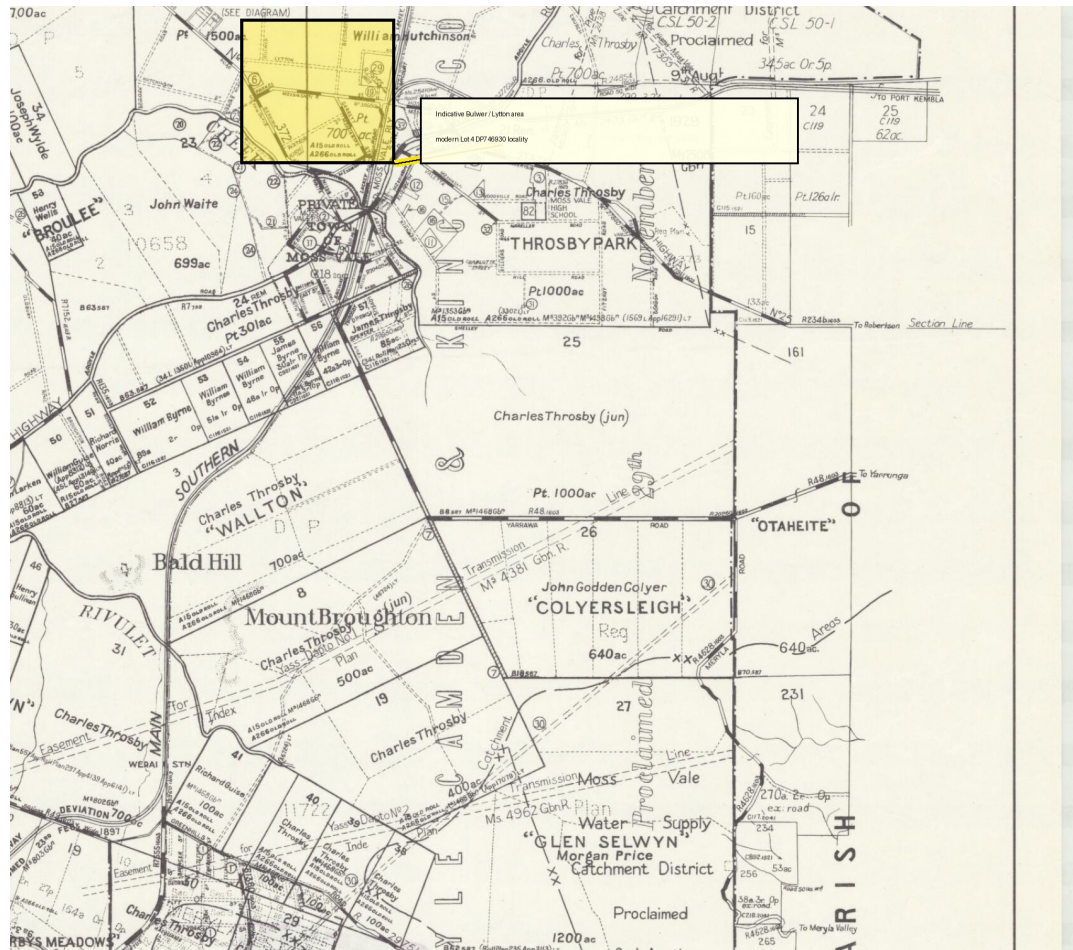
Source	Relevant details	Relevance
Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1942, 8th edition	Department of Lands parish map. NLA identifier nla.obj-233787591. Shows Moss Vale, Bong Bong parish, large rural holdings, road alignments and parish numbers used schedule.	Confirms the locality was mapped through rural parish portions and large acreages before modern industrial subdivision.
Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1968, 9th edition	Department of Lands parish map. NLA catalogue notes it is a cadastral map showing parish boundaries and land holdings. NLA identifier nla.obj-537799794.	Shows continuing rural/parish landholding context around Moss Vale and the Bulwer/Lytton locality.
Contract DP746930 plan	Shows DP746930 was a subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 and places the modern parcel in the Lytton/Bulwer road area.	Provides the modern-to-parent-plan bridge needed to compare with parish map location.

Parish Map Observations

- The Parish of Bong Bong maps show the Moss Vale locality in the context of older parish portions, old roll references and large acreage holdings, not as modern industrial land.
- Immediately around and north/east of the Moss Vale town area, the maps identify large rural holdings including William Hutchinson holdings of approximately 100, 150, 200 and 300 acres, John Waite holdings of approximately 699 to 700 acres, and Charles Throsby / Wallton / Throsby Park holdings ranging from hundreds to about 1000 acres.
- The indicative Bulwer/Lytton position sits beside the older Moss Vale township and adjacent to large-acreage parish land, including a "Pt 700ac" area shown on the 1968 parish map near the highlighted locality.
- The maps do not themselves state "cleared for agriculture", but their landholding pattern is consistent with the surrounding historical evidence that the area formed part of a rural/agricultural landscape before later industrial subdivision.
- To identify the exact Crown portion for modern Lot 4 DP746930, the next technical step remains ordering/tracing the NSW LRS historical title chain from Lot 4 DP746930 back through Lot 2 DP580513 to the earlier folio, volume, old roll or Crown portion references shown on the parish map.

Indicative Parish Map Extract

The highlighted area below is an indicative Bulwer/Lytton locality position on the 1968 Parish of Bong Bong map, used for orientation against the modern Lot 4 DP746930 location. It is not a surveyed overlay.



Source image: Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1968, Department of Lands, NLA object nla.obj-537799794; annotation prepared for this review.

Positive Evidence Contribution

The parish-map review strengthens the historical farming/agricultural position in three ways. First, it confirms that the land is in the Parish of Bong Bong, matching the contract title search. Second, it places the Bulwer/Lytton locality within an older pattern of large rural landholdings around Moss Vale rather than within a historically industrial setting. Third, it aligns with the Austermere Estate evidence that land in this broader locality was cleared, ploughable and marketed for agricultural, dairy, orchard and farming purposes by 1904.

Recommended Crown Plan / Title Follow-Up

- Order historical dealings and prior titles for Lot 2 DP580513, because DP746930 was created from that parent parcel.
- Use the prior title references to identify the old roll, volume/folio or Crown portion number that sits beneath the modern Lot 4 area.
- Once the prior portion is known, request the relevant Crown plan or old system title document from NSW LRS / HLRV and compare the portion against the parish map.
- Search the resulting old title/Crown plan for descriptors such as conditional purchase, homestead selection, grazing, cultivation, improvements, cleared, orchard, dairy, agricultural holding or farm.

The Crown plan step is likely to be the key missing link if a precise, parcel-specific historical farming statement is required.

Addendum Sources

- National Library of Australia, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1942, 8th ed., <http://nla.gov.au/nla.obj-233787591>.
- National Library of Australia catalogue, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1968, 9th ed., <http://nla.gov.au/nla.obj-537799794>.
- Exchanged Contract for Sale, 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale, including title search for Folio 4/746930 and DP746930 plan extract.